We know that, to win in India, we're going to have to bat effectively against spin and have top-quality spinners ourselves. Monty Panesar rejoins the team to combine with Graeme Swann, giving us two really strong spinners to match, or even surpass, India's. When we prepare, there's no huge team plan or information about the conditions, it's more about trusting each player to work out their own plan. Mushtaq Ahmed, England's spin-bowling coach, does drills with the batters with no pads on, making them work out how to get their feet moving and not get stuck on the crease. Each batter has their own approach – Cooky sweeps anything outside of his eyeline and has an absolutely flawless judgement of line and length. KP is more attacking against it, always keen to keep the scoreboard moving, backing himself to hit through the off side against the spin.

We do a lot of preparation with the ball before the series. In their conditions, the seam bowlers almost swap with the job required of spinners. I am expected to be incredibly miserly, not let the batters get away and tie down an end while the spinners bowl into the rough and uneven patches, trying to take the wickets. I realise that the over-emotional part of me will have to be contained and this will be about a consistent build-up of pressure, not letting the ego be dented by the changing of roles. I've been trying to watch as much of India as I can, analysing any tiny clues as to how they make it work for them. I watch a lot of Zaheer Khan, who has fashioned a way to being a wicket-taking threat as a seamer in India. I realise that, as he runs in, he hides the ball.

In Nagpur, for the fourth and final Test, we arrive leading 2-1. It's a shock to everyone – even slightly ourselves – after they have convincingly beaten us in the first game. But between us, we have found a way. Cook and Pietersen have scored big hundreds. Monty and Swanny have outbowled India in their own conditions. The pitch is completely dead and giving very little to me. They have offered up relatively fair wickets to bat on, maybe in concession that we carry as much of a threat with spinners as they do, and as a result it's very hard to find life on them. Sachin Tendulkar stands between me and another wicket. I've been hunting all tour on a diet of straight fields and relentless accuracy. The ball has reverse-swung for me at times, as it tends to much earlier in the subcontinent than in England. I have to occasionally take to my role as a 'spinner' with a technical and literal translation, bowling off cutters and leg cutters into the surface, making the